

1850

HISTORY OF MOTORBIKES

The motorbike had its beginnings in the late 19th century, when inventors discovered how to power bicycles with fuel-driven engines.



Daimler Reitwagen

1885 A gas-powered wooden bike is designed and built by German inventors Gottlieb Daimler and Wilhelm Maybach.

1894 The Hildebrand & Wolfmüller Motorrad is the first real motorcycle to come off a production line.



Hildebrand & Wolfmüller Motorrad

1908 The first-ever motorcycle race is held at Brooklands, Surrey, in England, and won by a 944cc NLG Peugeot bike.



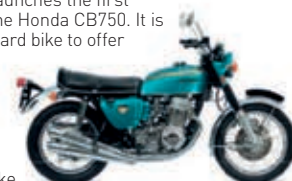
NLG Peugeot

1936 The first scooters are made in the USA. The Cushman Auto-Glide is produced in 1938 and later adapted for wartime use.



Auto-Glide Model 1

1969 Honda launches the first superbike – the Honda CB750. It is the first standard bike to offer features such as an overhead-camshaft four-cylinder engine and front disc brake.



Honda CB750



Mighty Mouse

1977 Raced by builder Brian Chapman, "Mighty Mouse" is the first dragster to cover 400 m (1,312 ft) in less than nine seconds.



Triumph Thunderbird 1600

2010 The world's biggest parallel-twin engine appears when the Triumph Thunderbird 1600 comes off the production line.

2011 The Triumph Rocket III Roadster features the biggest production motorcycle engine ever built.

2015



NSU 18PS SPORT 1924



EXCELSIOR JAP SPEEDWAY 1949



WESLAKE HOBBIT DRAGSTER 1978



HONDA RC30 1988



HONDA CBR900RR FIREBLADE 1992



SUZUKI GSX-R1100 1994



KAWASAKI ZX7R 1995



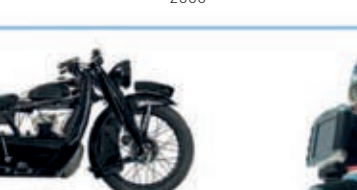
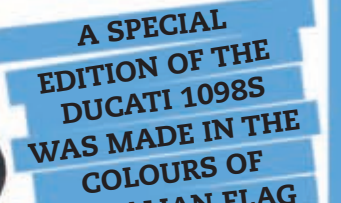
KAWASAKI NINJA ZX-12R 2000



TRIUMPH DAYTONA 675 2006



DUCATI 1098S 2007



FRANCIS-BARNETT CRUISER 1933



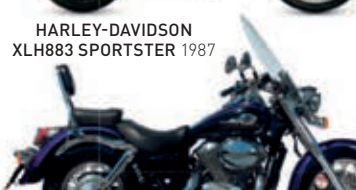
HONDA VF500C MAGNA 1983



HARLEY-DAVIDSON XLH883 SPORTSTER 1987



SUZUKI M1800R INTRUDER 2007



HONDA VT 750C2 SHADOW 1998



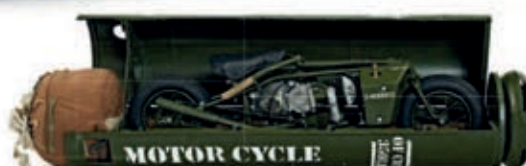
MOTO GUZZI CALIFORNIA EV 2001



TRIUMPH AMERICA 2012

WARTIME SPACE SAVER

During World War II, the British Army used a lightweight bike that could be dropped by parachute. Named the Welbike, it weighed just 34 kg (75 lb) and fitted into a small canister.



SCOOTER FOLDED INTO CANISTER



WELBIKE SCOOTER 1942



KIRBY BSA RACING SIDECAR 1968



BMW R50 COMBO 1957